

Compex Wireless Internet Gateway Kit

The Compex Wireless Internet Gateway Kit is a wireless access point (802.11g). It allows a broadband or dial-up connection to be distributed in both normal LAN and wireless forms. The Kit comprises the NetPassage 16A broadband Internet gateway box, which has a removable wireless PCMCIA card—the heart and soul of the package. It comes for Rs 9,500, and carries a three-year warranty. This is an excellent solution for any SoHo or home usage scenario, offering superb price-to-performance ratio with versatility. If you're shopping for a switch or hub, you can pay just a little extra and get yourself this wireless gateway kit.

Connecting the gateway takes about two minutes

SPECIFICATIONS

Supported standards: IEEE 802.3 10Base-T, IEEE 802.3u 100Base-TX, IEEE 802.3x Flow Control WAN Protocol: Static/Dynamic IP, PPP over Ethernet (PPPoE), Dana RAS WAN Interface: 1 x RJ45 Ethernet port LAN Interface: 4-port 10/100Mbps Fast Ethernet Switch

Price: Rs.9,500

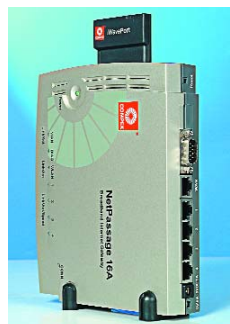
Company: Rashi Peripherals

Phone: 022-28260258

E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com

Web site: www.cpx.com

since everything is pre-configured. All you need to do is set your computers to DHCP, and connect the



incoming broadband or switch LAN cable to the WAN port on the gateway. You can also connect an external modem to the RS-232 port and set it up as a backup

connection.

Four LAN ports are provided. An uplink button lets you connect more than four PCs at the same time on the LAN, excluding the wireless option.

We tested the Internet gateway in different scenarios, such as WLAN, LAN and WAN. Data throughput was pretty good—4 MBps in the Wireless LAN and WAN scenarios. In the LAN simulation, the data throughput was a respectable 62 MBps.

There's one drawback: the WAN port is limited to 10 MBps. This automatically limits the other LAN ports to 10 MBps.

Compex Wireless Internet Gateway Kit B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Overall	▶▶▶▶▶

BenQ CB482B Combo Drive

The BenQ CB482B is a 48X/24X/48X CD-RW drive and a 16X DVD-ROM drive. It retails for Rs 4,000, which is quite high for a it's speeds—you can get 52X/24X/52X/16X drives from other manufacturers

for much less. The drive does come with a two-year warranty, but that does not justify its price. It comes bundled with a CD-R, CD-RW and the necessary software but is just an average performer.

In our performance tests, the drive gave good results in the Nero DVD Speed tests in the data transfer rate and access time tests. CPU utilisation was another department where the drive excelled, posting some of the lowest CPU utilisation scores. However, it suffered in the CD-burning tests and posted very average scores.

The drive supports the Mt. Rainier standard, which lets you use a CD-RW disk as a big floppy, provided the OS supports this. The software bundle is good, too. However, with absolutely

Price: Rs 4,000

Company: BenQ India Pvt Ltd

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Web site: www.benq.com



nothing special enough to justify its price, we suggest you give this drive a miss.

SPECIFICATIONS

16X (read) DVD; 48X (write) CD; 24X (rewrite) CD-RW; 48X (read) CD; E-IDE/ATAPI Interface; 2 MB buffer memory; flash memory firmware (upgradeable); supported writing modes: DAO/DAO-96, SAO, TAO

BenQ CB482B Combo Drive B-	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶

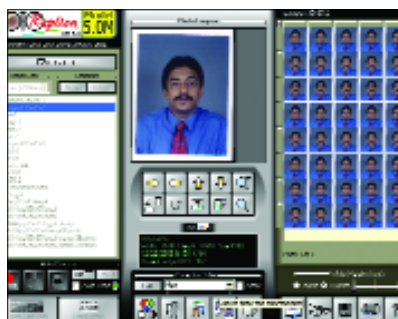
PhotoReplica Version 5

PhotoReplica is a good tool for digital photographers. With a small learning curve, a simple interface and low pricing, it makes printing

contrast, hue, etc.

Although this software is no match to the heavyweights from Adobe and Corel, it is definitely more affordable—priced between Rs 750 to Rs 2,750. The price varies because different versions handle different file sizes.

The software provides excellent colour correction, duo tone and a range of effects.



photos from a digital camera a breeze.

PhotoReplica is a tool to assist in printing, not editing. It has features such as index printing, creating preset size templates, etc., mainly to change colour overtone, brightness,

Price: 0.8M: Rs 750, 1.4M: Rs 950, 2.0M: Rs 1,250, 3.0M: Rs 1,650, 4.0M: Rs 2,150, 5.0M: Rs 2,750

SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

PIII 700 MHz or above, 128 MB RAM, colour monitor (24 bit at 800 x 600) and Windows 95/98/2000/XP. A printer, scanner, and digital camera helps you click and print

PhotoReplica Version 5 B-	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶